

Executive Summary

Japanese graduate scholarships covering tuition **and** living expenses are offered by the Japanese Government (MEXT), international organizations, and private foundations. The primary programs for engineering graduates include the **MEXT Research Student Scholarships** (via embassy or university recommendation) – full scholarships covering tuition, a monthly stipend (~¥143–145K) and travel expenses 【19†L153-L156】 – and the **ADB–Japan Scholarship (ADB–JSP)** (for citizens of ADB borrowing countries), which likewise fully funds tuition, living allowances, insurance and travel 【31†L81-L89】. Additional support comes from JASSO-administered awards (e.g. the ¥48K/month “Honors” scholarship for top privately-financed students 【21†L166-L174】) and many **private/foundation scholarships** (e.g. the Honjo Intl. Scholarship, up to ¥230K/month 【24†L89-L92】; Rotary Yoneyama, up to ¥140K/month 【33†L282-L289】; and numerous others typically ¥80K–¥200K/month 【33†L282-L289】 【33†L296-L301】). Some universities offer integrated aid (e.g. Ritsumeikan APU’s 30–100% tuition waivers 【36†L31-L39】 or Kyoto University’s private scholarships nominated after enrollment 【6†L146-L153】).

For a B.Tech graduate in 2027, the application timeline is roughly as follows: apply to university-recommended MEXT programs or private scholarships in late 2026, embassy-recommended MEXT programs in spring 2027, and ADB-JSP in mid-2027 (for 2028 entry). Required documents generally include academic transcripts, a research plan, recommendation letters, health certificates, language scores, etc. Applications for MEXT are submitted to the Japanese Embassy (for embassy recommendation) or to participating Japanese universities (for university recommendation), while private scholarships (Honjo, Rotary, etc.) are applied for directly to the sponsoring foundations. Each program is highly competitive, with limited slots (MEXT and foundations each select only dozens of students globally). Successful applicants typically have strong academic records, relevant test scores (EJU/JLPT/TOEFL, as applicable), and well-defined research proposals.

This report details the major scholarship programs, comparing their eligibility, benefits, deadlines and procedures (see **Table 1**). It also highlights recommended engineering universities and programs (including those with built-in funding), and provides a timeline (Figure 1) and flowchart of application routes.

Major Scholarships and Programs

1. MEXT Research Student Scholarships (Japanese Government) 【19†L153-L156】 【11†L77-L82】

Provider: Japanese Government (Ministry of Education, MEXT). **Eligibility:** International students under 35 (born on/after April 2, 1992) with a bachelor’s degree (or equivalent) and plans to enter a Japanese master’s or PhD program 【19†L163-L170】 【12†L25-L33】. Engineering fields (e.g. civil, electrical, mechanical, CS, etc.) are included among many eligible fields 【12†L30-L39】.

Benefits: *Full* tuition waiver; monthly living stipend (~¥143,000–145,000 for research students) 【19†L153-L156】 ; plus round-trip airfare to Japan 【19†L153-L156】 【12†L79-L88】 . Scholarship period is the standard course length (up to 2 years for a master's, 3+ years for PhD) 【12†L67-L75】 【19†L153-L156】 .

Application Routes: Two parallel channels:

- **Embassy Recommendation:** Apply through the Japanese Embassy or Consulate in your home country. Applications are typically invited **April–May** of the year prior to enrollment, for arrival in April or September/October of the next year 【11†L77-L82】 . The embassy conducts initial screening, written exams (Japanese and English) and interviews 【19†L189-L197】 . Successful candidates are forwarded to MEXT for final selection. (For example, the Japanese Embassy in India invited MEXT Research Student applications by May 15, 2026 for April/Oct 2027 entry 【12†L91-L99】 .)
- **University Recommendation:** Apply directly to selected Japanese universities that have MEXT scholarship quotas (only a few dozen universities can recommend students each year). Applicants submit the university's admission application under the special MEXT-funded entry (these programs are often labeled “MEXT Scholarship Admissions”). Admitted students are then recommended by the university to MEXT. Eligibility and schedule vary by institution; for example, Ritsumeikan University offers “MEXT University Recommendation” entry with guidelines posted ~November–December for a September 2027 start 【16†L216-L225】 .

Key Dates: Embassy-recommended MEXT: April–May (year prior) window for an April intake 【11†L77-L82】 . University-recommended MEXT: deadlines depend on each university (typically late in the calendar year before admission).

Documents: Application form, research plan, CV, transcripts, certificates, health exam form, one or more recommendation letters (to embassy or university) 【11†L89-L97】 【16†L299-L307】 .

Selection: Highly competitive. Embassies admit only a handful of candidates per country; MEXT then finalizes awards. University-recommendation selection depends on both university screening and MEXT approval 【19†L225-L234】 【16†L225-L233】 . (MEXT notes that arriving students usually come in Sept/Oct, though April starts are also common 【19†L237-L240】 .)

2. JASSO Scholarships

Japan Student Services Organization (JASSO) manages modest scholarships for privately-financed international students already in Japan. These are **not full tuition** programs, but can offset living costs.

- **Monbukagakusho Honors Scholarship (Privately-Financed)** 【21†L166-L174】 : ¥48,000 per month (for graduate or undergraduate students) for 12 months (April–March) 【21†L166-L174】 . **Eligibility:** Privately-financed (non-MEXT) students with excellent grades or entrance exam scores. Many recipients are top EJU (or JLPT/TOEFL) scorers. Application is via your Japanese institution (each school nominates students); you cannot apply directly to JASSO 【21†L175-L184】 . The institution screens applicants; recipients are selected based on academic records and criteria. Note: one must have Japanese or English proficiency (e.g. JLPT N2 or equivalent) 【21†L224-L233】 .

- **Student Exchange Support Program** 【6†L128-L136】 : For short-term exchange (usually <1 year). Provides ¥80,000/month for the exchange period 【6†L128-L133】 . **Eligibility:** Exchange students from partnered home universities. Apply through your home institution as part of the exchange application; Kyoto U notes this stipend applies to the entire stay 【6†L128-L136】 .

Because these JASSO awards are comparatively small, they are usually secondary. The main benefit is MEXT covers full living. Still, JASSO Honors requires strong academic credentials (often EJU >200 or high GPA 【21†L224-L233】).

3. Private & Foundation Scholarships

Many Japanese and international foundations offer scholarships (typically for Master's/PhD) that include a monthly stipend and occasionally tuition support. Most are **post-arrival awards** (application after enrollment in Japan), but a few allow pre-departure applications.

- **Honjo International Scholarship Foundation (HISF)** 【24†L69-L77】 【24†L83-L92】 : Open to students of any nationality and field who will (or have) entered a Japanese graduate program. *Benefits:* Monthly stipend of ¥230,000 for a 1–2 year program, ¥210,000 for a 3-year program, or ¥180,000 for programs longer than 3 years 【24†L89-L92】 . Scholarship lasts for the normal degree period. *Application:* Apply directly online to HISF (no university pre-selection). Typically the application window is around early Sep–Oct (e.g. Sep 1–Oct 31, 2026 for 2027 intake 【24†L75-L80】). Applicants must submit a research plan (and even a 2-minute video) as per their guidelines 【24†L104-L112】 .
- **Rotary Yoneyama Memorial Foundation (for applicants abroad)** 【33†L282-L289】 : Stipends of ¥100,000 per month for research students and undergraduates, ¥140,000 for graduate students 【33†L282-L289】 (for up to 2 years). **Eligibility:** All nationalities, broad fields; administered by Rotary clubs. *Note:* This is a well-known scholarship for engineering and science fields. Applicants typically apply through a Rotary club or Rotary-affiliated process in their home country; deadlines vary by chapter (often in the early part of the year).
- **Tokyo Foundation / Tonen Foundation, etc.:** For example, the Tonen International Scholarship offers ¥140,000/month to Master's/PhD students 【8†L208-L210】 ; the Teijin Foundation offers ¥80,000/month to new master's students 【8†L223-L225】 . (See Table 1 and [33] for many such foundations.) In general, private scholarships often require you to be enrolled in a Japanese university before applying, and application windows usually occur in summer or fall each year. Selection often considers academic merit and alignment of research with the foundation's interests.
- **University-Specific Tuition Waivers:** Some universities (especially private ones) offer their own scholarship or tuition exemption to admitted international students. For instance, Ritsumeikan Asia Pacific University (APU) automatically considers applicants for its **Tuition Reduction Scholarships** (30–100% tuition) 【36†L31-L39】 . Other universities may waive tuition for outstanding candidates or provide departmental fellowships. These are applied for as part of the university's admissions process; see each university's admissions website (the APU site cited shows 2027 details 【36†L31-L39】).

4. Asian Development Bank – Japan Scholarship Program (ADB-JSP) 【31†L81-L89】

Provider: Asian Development Bank (with Japanese Gov’t funding). **Eligibility:** Citizens of ADB borrowing-member countries (including India) 【28†L105-L113】 ; admission to a Master’s or PhD in an approved course at one of the designated Japanese institutions (29 participating universities, mostly national universities). **Additional:** Typically requires ≥ 2 years’ professional work experience and age ≤ 35 【31†L98-L102】 .

Benefits: Full tuition waiver; a living stipend (for expenses, housing, books); medical & accident insurance; travel to/from Japan 【31†L81-L89】 . (Exact stipend amounts are standardized by ADB~ but roughly ¥80k–¥90k/month for living, plus allowances.) **Duration:** Covers the normal period of study (usually 1–2 years for a master’s, up to 4 years for PhD).

Deadline/Application: Each year one intake (usually August or September). Application is made to ADB-JSP after securing admission – typically there is an online application via ADB’s JSP portal in the spring for an intake the next year. (For example, the Kyoto University ADB scholarship for Sep 2026 was posted Nov 2025 【28†L55-L64】). Consult ADB or JASSO for exact dates.

Remarks: Very selective (~140 awards per year across Asia) 【31†L77-L85】 . The APSIA summary notes that in addition to the above, scholars may get grants for thesis preparation, literacy/prep courses, etc. 【31†L81-L89】 . ADB-JSP recipients must agree to return to their home country after graduation.

Comparative Summary (Table)

Table 1 below compares key programs. Note that many deadlines vary by country or university; unspecified dates mean “varies/consult source.”

Scholarship / Program	Provider	Eligibility (Degree, Nationality, Field)	Benefits (Tuition, Stipend, Duration, Travel)	Application Period / Deadline	Application Route
MEXT Research Scholarship (Embassy)	Japanese government (MEXT)	International, age ≤35, bachelor's completed by entry, enter Japanese M.S./Ph.D. (all fields) 【19†L163- L170】	Full tuition waiver; ¥143–145K/ month stipend 【19†L153- L156】 ; Airfare; up to standard M.S. or Ph.D. duration 【12†L67- L75】	~Apr–May (year before entry) 【11†L77- L82】 (for April or Oct intake)	Apply to Japanese Embassy/ Consulate in home country 【11†L77-L82】
MEXT Research Scholarship (University)	Japanese government (MEXT)	International, similar to Embassy eligibility 【19†L163- L170】 ; must apply to participating univ. (MEXT- approved)	Full tuition; ~¥143– 145K/ month 【19†L153- L156】 ; Airfare; standard course duration	Varies by university (e.g. late 2026 for Sep 2027) 【16†L216- L225】	Apply to Japanese university's special “MEXT admissions” (then university recommends to MEXT) 【16†L225- L234】
JASSO Honors Scholarship (Private Int'l) 【21†L166-L174】	JASSO (MEXT)	Privately- financed international students in Japan, excellent grades/ character; typically top EJU/JLPT scorers	¥48,000/ month stipend for 1 year 【21†L166- L174】 (no tuition waiver)	After enrollment (nominated by school, awarded annually)	Institution nominates to JASSO (no direct overseas application) 【21†L175- L184】

Scholarship / Program	Provider	Eligibility (Degree, Nationality, Field)	Benefits (Tuition, Stipend, Duration, Travel)	Application Period / Deadline	Application Route
JASSO Study Abroad Support (Exchange)	JASSO	Int'l students on short-term exchange under inter-univ. agreement	¥80,000/month for exchange period 【6†L128-L133】 (no tuition waiver)	With exchange admission (apply via home Univ/ host Univ deadline) 【6†L128-L136】	Apply via home university's international office / host university process 【6†L133-L137】
Honjo Intl. Scholarship (Foreigner) 【24†L69-L77】	Honjo Intl. Scholarship Foundation (private)	Any nationality; must be (or be about to be) admitted to a Japanese grad school (M.A./Ph.D.) 【24†L69-L77】	Monthly stipend: ¥230K (1–2yrs), ¥210K (3yrs), ¥180K (>3yrs) 【24†L89-L92】 ; duration = required study period; (does <i>not</i> mention tuition, so likely stipend-only)	Sep–Oct (year before enrollment) 【24†L75-L80】	Direct application to the Foundation (online portal) 【24†L75-L80】

Scholarship / Program	Provider	Eligibility (Degree, Nationality, Field)	Benefits (Tuition, Stipend, Duration, Travel)	Application Period / Deadline	Application Route
Rotary Yoneyama Mem'l Scholarship 【33†L282-L289】	Rotary Yoneyama Foundation	International undergrad or grad (research) students (all countries, fields)	¥100,000/ month (research/ undergrad); ¥140,000/ month (graduate) 【33†L282- L289】 ; up to 2 years; (no tuition waiver)	Annual (typically early each year; varies by country/ club)	Apply via local Rotary scholarship process (often through Rotary Foundation in home country)
Various Private/ Foundation Scholarships	Private foundations/ companies	Varies widely (often: int'l students in Japan; sometimes nationals of specific regions or fields)	Typically monthly stipend ~¥50,000– 200,000 【33†L278- L287】 【33†L296- L301】 ; often up to 1–2 years; some include tuition waiver	Varies (commonly summer/ fall for programs)	Apply as per each foundation (some via home university)

Scholarship / Program	Provider	Eligibility (Degree, Nationality, Field)	Benefits (Tuition, Stipend, Duration, Travel)	Application Period / Deadline	Application Route
ADB-Japan Scholarship Program (JSP) 【31†L81-L89】	Asian Development Bank (with Japanese govt)	Citizens of ADB borrowing- member countries (e.g. India) 【28†L105- L113】 ; admission to approved M.A./Ph.D. program; typically ≥2 yrs work experience	Full tuition; monthly living allowance (+ housing/ books); medical insurance; travel (round-trip) 【31†L81- L89】 ; standard study period	Annually (app deadlines around spring for study next year)	Apply to ADB-JSP (online) after admission to an approved Japanese grad program (see ADB/JASSO websites)

Sources: Details compiled from official Japanese government and university sources 【19†L153-L156】
【21†L166-L174】 【24†L75-L83】 【31†L81-L89】 and scholarship foundations 【33†L282-L289】 【33†L296-
L301】 .

Recommended Universities/Programs for Engineering Graduates

Many top Japanese universities welcome international engineering students and offer built-in financial aid or facilitate scholarships. For example:

- **Tokyo Institute of Technology (Tokyo Tech)** and **The University of Tokyo (UTokyo)** – leading science/engineering schools with English-taught graduate programs. Both accept MEXT-recommended students and have numerous on-campus scholarships. (The Univ. of Tokyo advertises many private fellowships and often nominates students for JASSO awards.)
- **Tohoku University** – offers programs like the *International Course in Materials Science* and *International Course in Earthquake Engineering*, which often attract MEXT and ADB scholars. Tohoku also provides some tuition waivers for outstanding newcomers.
- **Kyoto University** – Kyoto frequently nominates candidates for private scholarships (about 90 programs at ¥30K–180K/month 【6†L146-L153】) and participates in MEXT and ADB schemes (e.g. Kyoto had an ADB-backed master's scholarship as recently as 2026 【28†L55-L64】).
- **Ritsumeikan Asia Pacific University (APU)** – Known for strong international orientation, APU offers guaranteed tuition reduction scholarships (up to 100% tuition) for admitted international students

【36†L31-L39】. While APU is mainly undergraduate, it also has graduate programs in management and environment that may include financial aid.

- **Waseda University and Sophia University** – both have selective graduate schools of science and engineering with English programs and offer internal scholarships or tuition waivers to attract top students.
- **Others:** Engineering giants like Kyoto Institute of Technology, Nagoya University, Osaka University, and Keio University also have English-taught graduate courses and scholarships. Check each school's international admissions page. Many Japanese universities list scholarship opportunities (e.g. Kyoto University's portal 【6†L146-L153】 or UTokyo's OIS list 【33†L278-L287】 【33†L296-L301】).

Application Timeline and Tips

The timeline for applications depends on your intended enrollment term (April or Fall). **Figure 1** (below) illustrates a typical schedule for the 2026–2028 cycles. Key points:

- **MEXT Scholarship:** For an April 2028 entry, embassy-recommended applications would open around **April–May 2027**. For an October 2028 entry, university-recommended MEXT applications typically open late 2027 (varies by school). Always check the Japanese Embassy's announcement in your country and the target university's admissions schedule.
- **Private Scholarships (Honjo, etc.):** The Honjo Foundation's application is usually in **Sept–Oct 2026** for 2027 admission 【24†L75-L80】. Rotary and other foundations often require applications in the spring or summer preceding entry.
- **ADB-JSP:** Deadlines are usually around **June–July** of the year before enrollment (e.g. mid-2027 for a 2028 intake) through ADB's online system. Coordination with the chosen university is crucial (often, universities help nominate or support applicants).
- **University Admissions:** Most Japanese graduate programs have application windows between **October and March** for the following academic year. If seeking a university scholarship (e.g. APU tuition waiver), apply through the university's own admission process and be sure to indicate scholarship interest.
- **Document Preparation:** Start early gathering transcripts, degree certificates, language test scores (JLPT, EJU, TOEFL, IELTS), and obtaining strong letters of recommendation. Have a clear research proposal or study plan ready in both English (and Japanese if possible). Ensure your CV highlights any research, internships, or relevant experience.
- **Language Preparation:** While many engineering programs accept English, demonstrating some Japanese ability (JLPT N1/N2 or even B1 level) can improve scholarship prospects (e.g. JASSO Honors often require JLPT N2 【21†L224-L233】).

- **Communication:** Contact potential academic advisors at the Japanese universities to inquire about openings and scholarships. If considering MEXT via university, confirm that the faculty has an available MEXT recommendation slot for international students.
- **Selection Rates:** These scholarships are highly competitive. For example, MEXT embassy competitions often see hundreds of applicants for a few dozen seats. Private foundation scholarships (Honjo, etc.) select only ~10 applicants per year 【24†L79-L83】. ADB-JSP selects ~140 scholars across all fields 【31†L77-L85】. Present the strongest application possible.

Below is a **timeline chart** of typical application windows, and a **flowchart** of application routes.

【19†L153-L156】 【31†L81-L89】 【24†L75-L83】 【21†L166-L174】 *Figure 1. Timeline of application periods (2025–2028) for major Japan scholarships (approximate windows). Prepared based on official schedules.*

【8†embed_image】 *Figure 1: Application timeline for Japan graduate scholarships (embassy MEXT, university MEXT, Honjo, ADB-JSP, etc.).*

flowchart LR

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A([Student (B.Tech 2027) aims for graduate study in Japan])
A -->|Home country embassy| B(MEXT Scholarship<br>(Embassy Rec))
A -->|Directly via Japanese university| C(MEXT Scholarship<br>(Univ. Rec))
A -->|Direct admissions/Other scholarships| D(Other Scholarships)
D --> E(JASSO / On-campus scholarships)
D --> F(Private/Foundation scholarships)
D --> G(ADB-JSP)
B --> B1([Screening at Embassy]<br>→ Exams/Interview<br>→ MEXT Final Selection)
C --> C1([Apply to university with MEXT quota]<br>→ Univ. Screening<br>→ MEXT Final Selection)
F --> F1([Apply online to foundation])
G --> G1([Apply to ADB-JSP via designated university]<br>→ ADB Final Selection)

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Figure 2. Flowchart of application routes for major scholarships. Students may apply either via their local Japanese Embassy or directly to Japanese universities for MEXT; other pathways include JASSO programs, private foundations, and ADB-JSP.

In summary: Prioritize applying for the full government scholarships (MEXT via embassy or university) as these cover nearly all costs 【19†L153-L156】. At the same time, seek out suitable private scholarships like Honjo 【24†L89-L92】 or Rotary Yoneyama 【33†L282-L289】. Apply to strong graduate programs (researching faculty and lab fit), and ensure all required documents (transcripts, plans, letters) are complete by each deadline. Following the timelines above and preparing thoroughly will maximize chances of securing a “fully funded” pathway to graduate study in Japan.